

TOWN OF FERNWICK

Town Council Minutes

Regular meeting of February 10, 2026, Council Chambers, Town Hall

Present: Mayor Dana Whitfield; Council Members Luis Ortega, Priya Raman, Tom Becker and Grace Holloway. Also present: Town Manager Alan Price, Town Clerk Maria Lindqvist and Town Engineer Sam Okafor.

1. Call to order

Mayor Whitfield called the meeting to order at 7:02 p.m. The Pledge of Allegiance was recited. The Clerk called the roll. All members were present.

2. Approval of minutes

Motion by Council Member Ortega, seconded by Council Member Raman, to approve the minutes of the January 13, 2026 regular meeting as presented. Motion carried 5-0.

3. Public comment

Three residents spoke. A resident of Brook Lane asked about snow removal on the sidewalks near the elementary school. A resident of Orchard Road supported the library roof repair. A resident of River Road asked when the spring leaf pickup schedule will be posted.

4. Old business

Main Street sidewalk project. Town Engineer Okafor reported that the design is 90 percent complete. The town has applied for a state grant of \$350,000. Construction could start in July if the grant is awarded. Council Member Becker asked about parking during construction. Mr. Okafor said most of the work will be done at night and the north side of Main Street will stay open.

Library roof repair. The Town Manager reported that bids open on March 2. The estimate is \$186,000. No action was taken.

5. New business

Snow and ice budget transfer. Motion by Council Member Holloway, seconded by Council Member Becker, to transfer \$45,000 from the contingency account to the snow and ice account. Motion carried 5-0.

Recycling contract. The council discussed a three-year extension of the contract with Valley Recycling Services. Motion by Council Member Raman, seconded by Council Member Ortega, to approve the extension at \$14.50 per household per month. Motion carried 4-1, with Council Member Becker opposed.

Planning Board vacancy. The Mayor announced one vacancy on the Planning Board. Applications are due March 1.

6. Department reports

The Police Chief reported 214 calls for service in January. Public Works crews treated roads during six storms. Parks and Recreation will open registration for spring programs on March 1.

7. Council comments

Council Member Holloway thanked the Public Works crews for their storm work. Council Member Raman reminded residents about the library's tax help sessions.

8. Adjournment

Motion by Council Member Ortega, seconded by Council Member Holloway, to adjourn at 8:41 p.m. Motion carried 5-0.

Respectfully submitted, Maria Lindqvist, Town Clerk.

Attachment: January 2026 department statistics

Department	January 2026	January 2025
Police calls for service	214	198
Fire and rescue calls	61	57
Storms treated	6	4
Building permits issued	18	22
Library visits	3,912	3,640

Approved by the Town Council on March 10, 2026.